

New Project Start — Quick Diagram



Quick summary

The startup flow is:

Create project folder → add `STATUS.md` → create `01-idea.md` → **define the current next action** → **follow the stages and keep `STATUS.md` updated.**

Your guide is built around `STATUS.md` being the file that always tells you or the agent what happens next.

The first 5 things to do

1. Create the new project folder

Start by creating a dedicated folder for the project under your projects area.

What to do:

- choose a clear project name
- create the folder
- treat this as the project's working home for all artifacts

Example:

```
mkdir projects/my-project
```

Why this matters:

- it gives the project a clean boundary
- it keeps the operating system separate from project execution
- it makes the project easy for an agent to scan and resume later

2. Copy in `STATUS.md`

Next, copy the starter `STATUS.md` into the new project folder.

What to do:

- copy the template from `project-starter/STATUS.md`
- place it in the project root
- immediately fill in the basic project status fields

At minimum, set:

- project name
- current stage
- stage status
- current action required
- who acts next
- artifact due next

Example:

```
Copy-Item project-starter/STATUS.md projects/my-project/STATUS.md
```

Why this matters:

- this is your control panel
- when you come back later, this file tells you where you are
- agents can read it first and continue without guesswork

3. Create `01-idea.md` from the idea template

Stage 1 is to copy `templates/idea-intake.md` into the project folder as `01-idea.md` and fill it in.

What to do:

- copy the idea template
- rename it to `01-idea.md`
- write down the first clear version of the idea

Include:

- what you want to build
- who it is for

- the problem it solves
- why it matters
- what success looks like
- any early constraints or preferences

Why this matters:

- it stops you from starting vaguely
 - it gives the AI something concrete to work from
 - it becomes the base for clarification and specification
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4. Define the immediate next action in `STATUS.md`

Once the idea file exists, update `STATUS.md` so it clearly states what must happen next.

What to do:

- set the current stage to **Idea Capture** if you are still drafting the idea, or **Clarification** if the idea is already captured
- write one plain-English next action
- identify who acts next: you, the agent, or both
- specify the next artifact due

Examples of good "current action required" entries:

- "Complete the initial idea statement and success criteria in `01-idea.md`."
- "Review `01-idea.md` and answer clarification questions to prepare `02-clarification.md`."
- "Ask the agent to generate a clarification checklist from the idea file."

Why this matters:

- it turns the project from a folder with files into an active workflow
 - it makes resuming work much easier
 - it gives an agent a clear handoff point
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5. Move through the stages and keep `STATUS.md` current

After setup, move through the workflow one stage at a time and update `STATUS.md` as you go.

The core stage flow is:

1. Idea Capture
2. Clarification

3. Specification
4. Technical Plan
5. Task Breakdown
6. Implementation
7. Review & Validation
8. Documentation
9. Handoff

What to do:

- open the relevant stage definition
- create the next artifact using the matching template
- complete one stage at a time
- update `STATUS.md` every time the project moves forward

Why this matters:

- it keeps the build structured
- it avoids jumping ahead too early
- it makes project continuity much stronger

Ultra-short version

The first 5 things are:

1. Create the project folder
2. Copy in `STATUS.md`
3. Create `01-idea.md` from the template
4. Fill in the current stage and next action in `STATUS.md`
5. Follow the workflow stage-by-stage and update `STATUS.md` as you go